

MUS 262 – Quiz #2 Study Guide

WithAI Research

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Date: Friday, March 27, 2026

Coverage: Weeks 4-7 (Bebop Continued, Hard Bop, Modal Jazz, Free Jazz)

Format: 20 points total

- 5 factual questions × 2 pts each = 10 pts
 - 1 listening response paragraph = 10 pts
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PART 1: FACTUAL QUESTIONS - ALL POSSIBLE Q&A;

Q-TYPE 1: Compare/Contrast Musical Characteristics

Q: How does Hard Bop differ from Bebop musically? (Two differences)

A:

1. **Tempo/Feel:** Hard Bop is generally slower and more groove-oriented than bebop's blazing fast tempos; emphasizes a funkier, blues-based feel
2. **Influences:** Hard Bop incorporated gospel, blues, and R&B influences, making it more accessible and "soulful" compared to bebop's purely virtuosic approach

Q: What are two musical differences between Modal Jazz and Hard Bop?

A:

1. **Harmonic approach:** Modal jazz uses scales/modes as the basis for improvisation rather than rapid chord changes; Hard Bop still uses complex chord progressions
2. **Texture:** Modal jazz often features simpler, more spacious accompaniment allowing soloists more freedom; Hard Bop has denser, more active rhythm sections

Q: How does Modal Jazz differ from Bebop in terms of improvisation?

A:

1. **Harmonic basis:** Modal jazz improvises over scales/modes; Bebop improvises over rapidly changing chord progressions
2. **Speed/space:** Modal jazz allows for more space and contemplation; Bebop emphasizes virtuosic speed and complex harmony

Q: What are two ways Free Jazz broke from traditional jazz conventions?

A:

1. **Harmony:** Free jazz abandoned traditional chord progressions and tonal centers entirely
 2. **Form:** Free jazz rejected standard song forms (AABA, 12-bar blues) in favor of collective improvisation and open structures
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Q-TYPE 2: Specific Concepts from Readings

Q: What is "modal jazz" and how does it differ from chord-based improvisation?

A: Modal jazz uses scales (modes) as the basis for improvisation rather than chord progressions. Instead of navigating through many changing chords, musicians improvise over one or two modes for extended periods, creating more spacious, meditative music. Example: "So What" uses just two modes (D Dorian and E $\flat$ Dorian).

Q: What is "hard bop" according to Szwed's Jazz 101?

A: Hard bop is a style that emerged in the mid-1950s as a reaction to cool jazz. It took bebop's foundation and added influences from gospel, blues, and R&B, creating a funkier, more soulful sound. It was particularly associated with Black musicians on the East Coast and emphasized groove and accessibility while maintaining bebop's virtuosity.

Q: What does Ingrid Monson describe as "saying something" in jazz?

A: Monson describes how jazz musicians communicate meaning through their playing - "saying something" means playing with emotional depth, cultural references, and conversational quality. It's about musical language and how musicians interact, respond, and express identity through improvisation.

Q: What does Paul Berliner mean by "thinking in jazz"?

A: Berliner describes how jazz musicians develop an internalized vocabulary of patterns, phrases, and harmonic concepts that become second nature. "Thinking in jazz" means having a mental library of musical ideas that can be spontaneously recalled and recombined during improvisation - it's learned through intensive practice and listening.

Q: What is a "contrafact" in bebop?

A: A contrafact is a new melody written over the chord changes of an existing song. Bebop musicians used this technique extensively - for example, "Ko Ko" is a contrafact over "Cherokee" changes. This allowed them to avoid paying royalties while still using familiar harmonic structures.

Q: What is "soul jazz" according to Szwed?

A: Soul jazz is a substyle of hard bop that particularly emphasized funky, gospel-influenced grooves. It was closely tied to Black church music and R&B, featuring simpler harmonies, repeated riffs, and organ-based groups. Artists like Horace Silver epitomized this style.

Q: What is a "mode" in modal jazz?

A: A mode is a type of scale derived from altering which note serves as the tonic. In modal jazz, improvisers use a mode (like Dorian or Mixolydian) as the harmonic foundation for extended periods, rather than changing through multiple chords. This creates a static, hypnotic quality.

Q-TYPE 3: Historical Evolution

Q: How did bebop evolve into Hard Bop in the 1950s? (Two ways)

A:

1. **Cultural shift:** Hard bop reasserted Black cultural identity by incorporating gospel and blues elements; it was a response to cool jazz's "whitening" of bebop
2. **Musical approach:** Hard bop slowed down bebop's frantic tempos and emphasized groove and feeling over pure technical virtuosity

Q: Name two ways Modal Jazz (1959) differed from Hard Bop of the 1950s

A:

1. **Harmonic complexity:** Modal jazz simplified harmony to one or two modes; Hard Bop retained complex chord progressions
2. **Improvisation approach:** Modal jazz gave soloists more freedom to explore melodically; Hard Bop required navigating specific chord changes

Q: How did Free Jazz break from bebop traditions? (Two ways)

A:

1. **Abandoning tonality:** Free jazz rejected traditional harmonic structures entirely; bebop still operated within functional harmony
2. **Collective improvisation:** Free jazz emphasized group interaction without predetermined forms; bebop had clear head-solos-head structure

Q: What is the timeline progression from Bebop to Free Jazz?

A:

- **Bebop (early 1940s):** Complex harmony, fast tempos, virtuosic improvisation (Parker, Gillespie)
- **Hard Bop (mid-1950s):** Added soul, gospel, blues; funkier grooves (Blakey, Silver)
- **Modal Jazz (1959):** Simplified harmony to modes; more space and freedom (Davis, Coltrane)
- **Free Jazz (early 1960s):** Abandoned all traditional structures; complete freedom (Coleman, Taylor)

Q-TYPE 4: Artist Comparisons

Q: How does Thelonious Monk's piano style differ from Bud Powell's?

A:

1. **Touch/technique:** Monk played with flat fingers creating a percussive, angular sound; Powell used conventional technique with flowing lines
2. **Harmonic approach:** Monk used dissonant tone clusters and unexpected note choices; Powell played bebop vocabulary with clear harmonic logic

Q: Compare Miles Davis's approaches in "Oleo" (Hard Bop) vs. "So What" (Modal Jazz)

A:

1. **"Oleo":** Fast bebop tempo with rapid chord changes (rhythm changes); requires virtuosic navigation of harmony
2. **"So What":** Slow, spacious modal approach with just two modes; emphasizes melodic development and space over technical display

Q: How does John Coltrane's playing differ between "Giant Steps" and "My Favorite Things"?

A:

1. **"Giant Steps":** Complex chord changes moving through three tonal centers; showcases "sheets of sound" and harmonic mastery
2. **"My Favorite Things":** Modal improvisation over vamp; uses soprano sax; more repetitive, trance-like quality

Q: How do Sonny Rollins and John Coltrane differ as tenor saxophonists?

A:

1. **Rollins:** More playful, rhythmically inventive, uses calypso and Caribbean influences ("St. Thomas"); focuses on melodic development

2. **Coltrane:** More spiritually intense, harmonically complex; used "sheets of sound" and modal exploration; deeper, darker tone

Q: How does Ornette Coleman's approach to jazz differ from Charlie Parker's bebop?

A:

1. **Harmony:** Coleman abandoned chord changes entirely (free improvisation); Parker was a master of navigating complex harmony
2. **Tone:** Coleman used a raw, vocal-like plastic alto sax sound; Parker had a pure, controlled bebop tone

Q: Compare Horace Silver's piano style to Thelonious Monk's

A:

1. **Silver:** Funky, gospel-influenced, accessible; clear melodic ideas; founded soul jazz
 2. **Monk:** Angular, dissonant, idiosyncratic; used space and unexpected harmony; more challenging
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Q-TYPE 5: Movement Characteristics

Q: Name two defining characteristics of Hard Bop

A:

1. **Gospel/blues influence:** Incorporated church music, R&B, and blues into bebop's foundation; funkier, more soulful
2. **Strong rhythm section:** Emphasized groove and swing; drummers like Art Blakey drove the band with powerful, interactive playing

Q: Name two defining characteristics of Modal Jazz

A:

1. **Scale-based improvisation:** Used modes (scales) instead of chord progressions as harmonic foundation
2. **Spaciousness:** Slower tempos, less harmonic density, more room for melodic exploration and contemplation

Q: Name two defining characteristics of Free Jazz

A:

1. **No predetermined harmony:** Abandoned chord progressions and tonal centers entirely; completely free improvisation
2. **Collective improvisation:** All musicians improvised simultaneously without soloist/accompanist roles; no fixed forms or structures

Q: What is "cool jazz" and how does it relate to Hard Bop?

A: Cool jazz was a West Coast style emphasizing lighter tones, subdued emotions, and classical influences (Miles Davis's "Birth of the Cool"). Hard Bop emerged on the East Coast as a direct reaction to cool jazz - reasserting Black cultural identity, incorporating gospel and blues, and emphasizing groove and soul.

Q: What innovations did the 1959 album "Kind of Blue" bring to jazz?

A:

1. **Modal jazz:** First major album to use modes instead of chord changes as primary harmonic structure

2. **Spontaneity:** Most tracks were first takes with minimal rehearsal; created a spacious, contemplative sound that became hugely influential

Q: What is the "sheets of sound" technique associated with John Coltrane?

A: "Sheets of sound" describes Coltrane's technique of playing rapid cascades of notes that create a dense, waterfall-like effect. He would play arpeggios and scales at extremely fast tempos, especially in his Hard Bop period ("Giant Steps"), creating an almost overwhelming harmonic density.

Key Terms to Know

Musical Terms:

- **Modal improvisation:** Improvising using scales/modes rather than chord changes
- **Dorian mode:** A mode commonly used in modal jazz (minor scale with raised 6th)
- **Vamp:** A repeated chord progression or rhythmic pattern (common in modal jazz)
- **Ostinato:** A repeated musical phrase (often bass line in modal jazz)
- **Polytonal/polyrhythmic:** Using multiple tonal centers or rhythms simultaneously (Free Jazz)
- **Atonality:** Music without a tonal center (Free Jazz)
- **Collective improvisation:** All musicians improvising simultaneously
- **Pedal point:** A sustained bass note while harmony changes above it
- **Time signature changes:** Unusual meters like 5/4 ("Take Five"), 6/8, 3/4

Stylistic Terms:

- **Hard bop:** 1950s bebop + gospel/blues/R&B; influences
- **Soul jazz:** Funky, gospel-influenced subgenre of hard bop
- **Cool jazz:** West Coast style with lighter tones, classical influences
- **Modal jazz:** Style based on modes rather than chord progressions
- **Free jazz:** Complete abandonment of traditional jazz structures
- **Avant-garde:** Experimental, boundary-pushing approach

Artists & Nicknames:

- **"Prez"** - Lester Young
 - **"Bird"** - Charlie Parker
 - **"Monk"** - Thelonious Monk
 - **"Trane"** - John Coltrane
 - **"Cannonball"** - Julian Adderley
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PART 2: LISTENING GUIDE - ALL 26 SONGS

WEEK 4: BEBOP, CONTINUED

Thelonious Monk – "Criss Cross" (1951)

Album: Genius of Modern Music, Vol. 2

Personnel: Monk (piano), Milt Jackson (vibraphone), others

What to Listen For:

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- **Angular, dissonant melody:** The head has unexpected intervals and dissonant harmonies - very "Monkish"
 - **Percussive piano style:** Monk plays with flat fingers, creating a jabbing, percussive sound
 - **Use of space:** Monk leaves deliberate silences between phrases
 - **Dissonant tone clusters:** Uses adjacent notes played together for harmonic tension
 - **Milt Jackson's vibraphone:** Clear, ringing sound contrasts with Monk's percussive piano
 - **Complex form:** According to Schuller, this was the first jazz piece with musical coherence comparable to European classical music
 - **Medium tempo:** Not as fast as typical bebop; allows for contemplation of the angular melody

Key Terms: dissonance, angularity, tone clusters, percussive attack, vibraphone, flat-fingered technique

Historical Context: Recorded 1951, but Monk didn't achieve critical acclaim until late 1950s. This piece shows his unique compositional approach - he's considered the greatest jazz composer after Duke Ellington.

Thelonious Monk – "Round Midnight" (1957)

Album: Thelonious Himself

Solo piano

What to Listen For:

- **AABA form with introduction and coda:** Standard song structure but with Monk's personal touches
- **Ballad tempo:** Slow, contemplative - shows Monk's lyrical side
- **Rich harmonic palette:** Uses substitute chords and unexpected resolutions
- **Melodic singability:** Despite being complex harmonically, the melody is memorable and singable
- **Damper pedal use:** Monk creatively uses the sustain pedal to blend harmonies
- **Solo piano:** No accompaniment - pure Monk
- **Rubato timing:** Free timing, not strict rhythm - adds emotional depth
- **Jazz standard:** One of the most recorded jazz compositions ever; covered by countless artists

Key Terms: ballad, AABA form, harmonic substitution, rubato, damper pedal, solo piano, introduction, coda

Historical Context: Written in the 1940s at Minton's Playhouse; became a jazz standard. This 1957 recording shows Monk's mature, lyrical approach to his most famous composition.

Sonny Stitt – "Cherokee" (1950)

Album: Kaleidoscope

Alto saxophone

What to Listen For:

- **Extremely fast tempo:** Blistering bebop speed - a test of virtuosity
- **Ray Noble chord changes:** Uses the chord progression from "Cherokee" (same changes as Parker's "Ko Ko")
- **Long melodic lines:** Stitt plays extended phrases at breakneck speed
- **Clean articulation:** Despite the speed, every note is clear
- **Bebop vocabulary:** Characteristic bebop phrases, arpeggios, chromatic runs
- **Alto saxophone:** Stitt was known as one of the few who could match Charlie Parker's alto playing
- **Head-solos-head form:** Standard bebop structure

Key Terms: virtuosity, Cherokee changes, articulation, bebop phrasing, arpeggios, chromatic runs

Historical Context: Sonny Stitt (1924-1982) was often compared to Charlie Parker; some accused him of copying Bird, but Stitt had his own voice. This recording shows pure bebop mastery.

Dexter Gordon – "Long Tall Dexter" (1946)

Album: Settin' the Pace

Tenor saxophone

What to Listen For:

- **Tenor saxophone:** Big, warm tone - different from alto sax
- **Laid-back phrasing:** Gordon plays "behind the beat" - relaxed, conversational feel
- **Blues influence:** Strong blues feeling throughout
- **Medium-up tempo:** Not as frantic as some bebop; more relaxed
- **Clear melodic ideas:** Gordon emphasizes melody and story-telling over pure technical display
- **Swing feel:** Despite being bebop, maintains strong connection to swing era
- **Bebop vocabulary adapted to tenor:** Shows how bebop translated from Parker's alto to tenor sax

Key Terms: tenor saxophone, laid-back phrasing, behind the beat, blues-inflected, melodic development

Historical Context: Dexter Gordon (1923-1990) was one of the first bebop tenor saxophonists, translating Parker's alto innovations to the bigger horn. He later became famous for the film "Round Midnight" (1986).

WEEK 5: HARD BOP

Art Blakey – "Blues March" (1958)

Album: Moanin'

Art Blakey and the Jazz Messengers

Personnel: Lee Morgan (trumpet), Benny Golson (tenor sax), Bobby Timmons (piano), Jymie Merritt (bass), Art Blakey (drums)

What to Listen For:

- **Marching blues feel:** Combines blues structure with march-like rhythm
- **Powerful drumming:** Blakey's thunderous, driving drum work propels the band
- **Call and response:** Horns play riff patterns that answer each other
- **Gospel influence:** Church-like feel in the harmonies and rhythm
- **12-bar blues form:** Traditional blues structure
- **Hard-swinging rhythm section:** Demonstrates the hard bop aesthetic
- **Lee Morgan's bright trumpet:** Young Lee Morgan (18 years old!) plays with fire and precision
- **Group sound:** Ensemble unity - the Jazz Messengers' signature tight, powerful approach

Key Terms: blues march, hard bop, gospel influence, call and response, powerful drumming, Jazz Messengers, ensemble playing

Historical Context: Art Blakey's Jazz Messengers were the quintessential hard bop group. Blakey was a master at nurturing young talent; this group features teenage Lee Morgan who would become a major star.

Horace Silver – "Song For My Father" (1965)

Album: Song for My Father

Piano

What to Listen For:

- **Latin/bossa nova rhythm:** Brazilian-influenced groove
- **Simple, catchy melody:** Highly memorable, singable theme
- **Funky piano comping:** Silver's signature bluesy, gospel-influenced chords
- **Vamp-based structure:** Built on repeated bass pattern (ostinato)
- **Soul jazz:** Exemplifies the soulful, accessible side of hard bop
- **Medium tempo:** Relaxed, grooving feel
- **Church-influenced harmony:** Gospel chord progressions
- **Modal elements:** Uses relatively static harmony over the vamp

Key Terms: bossa nova, Latin jazz, vamp, ostinato, soul jazz, gospel harmony, comping, modal

Historical Context: Horace Silver (1928-2014) was a founder of hard bop and soul jazz. This became one of his most famous compositions and a jazz standard. Written as tribute to his Cape Verdean father.

Sonny Rollins – "St. Thomas" (1956)

Album: Saxophone Colossus

Tenor saxophone

What to Listen For:

- **Calypso rhythm:** Caribbean/West Indian groove (Rollins' mother was from Virgin Islands)
- **Simple, folk-like melody:** Based on traditional Caribbean song
- **Rollins' playful improvisation:** Rhythmic invention, quotes other melodies, humor
- **Strong melodic development:** Rollins builds logically on the main theme
- **Medium tempo:** Danceable, infectious groove
- **Thematic improvisation:** Uses motifs from the head throughout solos
- **Tenor saxophone:** Rollins' big, bold, confident tone
- **Caribbean influence in jazz:** Shows hard bop's openness to world music influences

Key Terms: calypso, Caribbean influence, thematic improvisation, motivic development, melodic invention

Historical Context: *Saxophone Colossus* (1956) is one of the greatest jazz albums ever made. This track showcases Rollins' unique approach - incorporating Caribbean heritage while maintaining bebop sophistication.

Miles Davis – "Boplicity" (1949)

Album: Birth of the Cool

Trumpet

What to Listen For:

- **Cool jazz aesthetic:** Subdued, understated emotion; lighter tones
- **Medium-slow tempo:** Relaxed compared to bebop

- **Arranged textures:** Not just head-solos-head; through-composed arrangements
- **French horn, tuba:** Unusual jazz instrumentation creating orchestral color
- **Gil Evans arrangement:** Complex, impressionistic harmonic voicings
- **Soft dynamics:** No screaming or aggressive playing
- **Classical influences:** Influenced by European concert music
- **Nonet (9 pieces):** Unusual jazz ensemble size - between small group and big band

Key Terms: cool jazz, nonet, arranged textures, orchestral color, impressionistic harmony, subdued emotion, French horn, tuba

Historical Context: *Birth of the Cool* sessions (1949-1950) created "cool jazz" movement - reaction against bebop's intensity. Influenced by Claude Thornhill Orchestra's sound. Arranged by Gil Evans.

Miles Davis – "Oleo" (1956)

Album: Relaxin' With the Miles Davis Quintet

First Great Quintet: Miles (trumpet), John Coltrane (tenor sax), Red Garland (piano), Paul Chambers (bass), Philly Joe Jones (drums)

What to Listen For:

- **Fast bebop tempo:** Uptempo hard bop workout
- **Rhythm changes:** Based on "I Got Rhythm" chord progression (32-bar AABA)
- **Head-solos-head form:** Standard bebop structure
- **Miles' muted trumpet:** Uses Harmon mute for softer, more intimate tone
- **Coltrane's sheets of sound:** Dense, rapid note cascades
- **Red Garland's block chords:** Piano plays thick, orchestral voicings behind solos
- **Philly Joe Jones' drumming:** Interactive, conversational drumming pushing soloists
- **First Great Quintet:** One of the most important groups in jazz history
- **Hard bop aesthetic:** Virtuoso but swinging; maintains groove despite speed

Key Terms: rhythm changes, Harmon mute, sheets of sound, block chords, interactive drumming, hard bop

Historical Context: Miles' First Great Quintet (1955-1957) defined 1950s hard bop. These "Prestige sessions" were recorded quickly to fulfill contract obligations before Miles moved to Columbia.

Cannonball Adderley – "Sack O' Woe" (1960)

Album: At the Lighthouse

Alto saxophone

What to Listen For:

- **Funky, bluesy melody:** Soul jazz aesthetic
- **Cannonball's full, round alto tone:** Big sound - unlike typical bebop alto
- **Medium groove:** Emphasis on feel and swing over speed
- **Gospel influence:** Church-like harmonies and phrasing
- **Call and response:** Piano and sax trade phrases
- **12-bar blues form:** Traditional structure
- **Accessible, soulful:** Hard bop's connection to Black church and popular music

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- **Live recording:** Recorded at the Lighthouse Cafe; audience energy

Key Terms: soul jazz, funk, gospel influence, full tone, blues form, live recording

Historical Context: Julian "Cannonball" Adderley (1928-1975) got his nickname from "cannibal" - he ate so much! He played with Miles Davis' sextet (on *Kind of Blue*) but also led his own funky, soulful groups.

Charles Mingus – "Better Git It in Your Soul" (1959)

Album: Mingus Ah Um

Bass, composer, bandleader

What to Listen For:

- **Gospel/church influence:** Sounds like church service; hand-clapping, call and response
- **Mingus shouting/preaching:** Vocals urging musicians like a preacher
- **Complex arrangement:** Through-composed sections alternating with improvisation
- **Collective improvisation:** Multiple horns playing together
- **6/8 gospel time:** Swaying, churchy rhythm
- **Bass as lead voice:** Mingus' virtuosic bass playing
- **Dynamic contrasts:** Loud/soft, dense/sparse textures
- **Organized chaos:** Seems wild but is carefully structured
- **Political/spiritual message:** Mingus' music often carried social commentary

Key Terms: gospel, hand-clapping, collective improvisation, through-composed, 6/8 time, organized chaos, political music

Historical Context: Charles Mingus (1922-1979) was a bassist, composer, and bandleader known for fiery temperament and politically conscious music. *Mingus Ah Um* (1959) is one of his masterpieces.

John Coltrane – "Giant Steps" (1960)

Album: Giant Steps

Tenor saxophone

What to Listen For:

- **Extremely fast tempo:** Blistering speed - test of virtuosity
- **Complex chord changes:** Moves through three tonal centers; "Coltrane changes"
- **"Sheets of sound":** Rapid cascades of notes creating dense harmonic texture
- **Virtuosic technique:** Unprecedented technical mastery on tenor sax
- **Tommy Flanagan's piano solo:** Pianist struggles with the difficult changes
- **Brief, intense:** Under 5 minutes but exhausting
- **Composed by Coltrane:** Shows his theoretical/compositional sophistication
- **No blues or simple forms:** Pure harmonic complexity
- **Bebop taken to extreme:** Harmony becomes so complex it begins to break down traditional approaches

Key Terms: Coltrane changes, sheets of sound, three-tonal-center modulation, virtuosity, harmonic complexity

Historical Context: "Giant Steps" represents the pinnacle of chord-based improvisation in jazz. Coltrane would soon abandon this approach for modal jazz, as heard on *My Favorite Things* the same year.

WEEK 6: MODAL JAZZ

Miles Davis – "So What" (1959)

Album: Kind of Blue

Sextet: Miles (trumpet), Cannonball Adderley (alto sax), John Coltrane (tenor sax), Bill Evans (piano), Paul Chambers (bass), Jimmy Cobb (drums)

What to Listen For:

- **Modal structure:** Only two modes - D Dorian for 16 bars, E $\flat$ Dorian for 8 bars, back to D Dorian for 8 bars
- **Bass ostinato:** Paul Chambers' repeated bass riff defines the tune
- **Piano/bass call and response:** Opening dialogue between Bill Evans and bass
- **Spacious, relaxed:** Slower tempo allows melodic exploration
- **No complex chord changes:** Just two modes for entire piece
- **Miles' Harmon mute:** Intimate, whispering trumpet sound
- **Coltrane's modal improvisation:** Uses modes to build melodic ideas
- **Bill Evans' impressionistic piano:** Voicings influenced by classical impressionism
- **First take spontaneity:** Recorded with minimal rehearsal
- **Cool, understated:** Contrast to hard bop's intensity

Key Terms: modal jazz, Dorian mode, ostinato, call and response, Harmon mute, impressionistic harmony, spontaneity

Historical Context: *Kind of Blue* (1959) is the best-selling jazz album of all time. This track defined modal jazz and influenced all subsequent jazz. Recorded in one take with minimal rehearsal.

Miles Davis – "Riot" (1967)

Album: Nefertiti

Second Great Quintet: Miles, Wayne Shorter (tenor sax), Herbie Hancock (piano), Ron Carter (bass), Tony Williams (drums)

What to Listen For:

- **Post-bop abstraction:** More experimental than earlier modal work
- **Wayne Shorter composition:** Abstract, mysterious melody
- **Tony Williams' explosive drumming:** Young drummer (21) playing with incredible energy
- **Herbie Hancock's harmonic ambiguity:** Chords that don't clearly define tonality
- **Loose form:** Less structured than "So What"
- **Group interaction:** Musicians respond to each other conversationally
- **Shorter's dark tenor tone:** Mysterious, searching quality
- **Foreshadows fusion:** Moving toward the electric experiments of *Bitches Brew*
- **Complex rhythmic interplay:** Not just keeping time - drums and bass create polyrhythmic textures

Key Terms: post-bop, Second Great Quintet, harmonic ambiguity, polyrhythm, collective improvisation, abstract

Historical Context: Miles' Second Great Quintet (1964-1968) pushed modal jazz into more abstract territory. This group featured some of the most innovative musicians of the era, all still developing their own voices.

John Coltrane – "My Favorite Things" (1961)

Album: My Favorite Things

Soprano saxophone

What to Listen For:

- **Soprano saxophone:** Coltrane's breakthrough on this instrument; high, penetrating sound
- **Modal vamp:** Repeated two-chord pattern (E minor to E major)
- **Waltz time (3/4):** Unusual meter for jazz; from Rodgers & Hammerstein musical
- **Long solos:** Extended modal improvisation (album version is 13+ minutes)
- **Hypnotic, trance-like:** Repetitive vamp creates meditative quality
- **Indian music influence:** Drone-like quality; spiritual searching
- **McCoy Tyner's piano:** Quartal voicings (chords built on 4ths) become signature sound
- **Elvin Jones' polyrhythmic drumming:** Complex cross-rhythms over waltz feel
- **Spiritual quality:** Coltrane's growing interest in spirituality and Eastern philosophy
- **Popular success:** Became Coltrane's most commercially successful recording

Key Terms: soprano saxophone, modal vamp, 3/4 waltz time, hypnotic, quartal harmony, polyrhythm, spiritual jazz

Historical Context: This recording marked Coltrane's shift from complex harmony ("Giant Steps") to modal exploration. His "Classic Quartet" (Tyner, Garrison, Jones) became one of jazz's greatest groups.

Bill Evans – "Nardis" (1961)

Album: Explorations

Piano Trio: Bill Evans (piano), Scott LaFaro (bass), Paul Motian (drums)

What to Listen For:

- **Delicate, introspective:** Quiet, contemplative mood
- **Conversational trio:** Bass and drums are equal partners, not just accompaniment
- **Scott LaFaro's bass:** Melodic, interactive bass lines - revolutionary approach
- **Bill Evans' voicings:** Impressionistic, classical-influenced chord voicings
- **Minor key, melancholy:** Composed by Miles Davis; sad, reflective melody
- **Rubato sections:** Free timing in places
- **Sparse texture:** Space and silence are important
- **Interplay:** All three musicians listen and respond to each other constantly
- **Chamber jazz:** Intimate, classical music-like approach

Key Terms: piano trio, conversational interplay, impressionistic, melodic bass, rubato, chamber jazz, sparse texture

Historical Context: Bill Evans Trio with Scott LaFaro redefined the jazz piano trio. LaFaro died in car accident shortly after these recordings, making them even more poignant. This is one of the most influential trios in jazz history.

Dave Brubeck – "Take Five" (1959)

Album: Time Out

Piano; composition by Paul Desmond (alto sax)

What to Listen For:

- **5/4 time signature:** Unusual meter - five beats per measure (3+2 or 2+3 grouping)
- **Paul Desmond's cool alto:** Light, airy tone; lyrical, singable melody
- **Catchy, accessible:** Despite odd meter, became hugely popular
- **Joe Morello's drum solo:** Extended drum solo in 5/4 - technically impressive
- **Vamp-based:** Repeated piano pattern establishes the 5/4 groove
- **West Coast cool jazz:** Lighter, more cerebral than East Coast hard bop
- **Classical influence:** Brubeck studied with Darius Milhaud
- **Commercial success:** Became first jazz instrumental to sell over a million copies
- **Intellectual cool:** Shows jazz's connection to classical experimentation

Key Terms: 5/4 time, odd meter, cool jazz, vamp, accessible, classical influence, West Coast jazz

Historical Context: Dave Brubeck Quartet experimented with unusual time signatures on *Time Out* album. "Take Five" became an unlikely hit, proving jazz could be both experimental and popular.

Herbie Hancock – "Maiden Voyage" (1965)

Album: Maiden Voyage

Piano, composer

What to Listen For:

- **Suspended chords:** Uses sus chords creating floating, open quality
- **Ocean imagery:** Music evokes sailing, waves, open sea
- **Modal approach:** Limited harmonic movement allows melodic freedom
- **Freddie Hubbard's trumpet:** Bright, lyrical trumpet melody
- **George Coleman's tenor:** Flowing, melodic improvisation
- **Light, airy texture:** Spacious arrangement
- **AABA-like structure:** But with modal harmony instead of functional chords
- **Pristine recording quality:** Blue Note's famous Rudy Van Gelder sound
- **Modern jazz classic:** Became a standard; perfect example of mid-60s modal jazz
- **Optimistic mood:** Uplifting, positive feeling - contrast to hard bop's intensity

Key Terms: suspended chords, modal harmony, open voicings, Blue Note sound, spacious texture

Historical Context: Herbie Hancock was a member of Miles' Second Great Quintet. This album showcases his composing and leading skills. "Maiden Voyage" has become one of the most-played jazz standards.

Stan Getz – "The Girl from Ipanema" (1964)

Album: Getz/Gilberto

Tenor saxophone

Featuring: João Gilberto (guitar/vocals), Astrud Gilberto (vocals), Antonio Carlos Jobim (piano)

What to Listen For:

- **Bossa nova rhythm:** Brazilian style - samba-influenced but softer, more sophisticated
- **João Gilberto's quiet guitar:** Subtle, syncopated guitar patterns

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- **Astrud Gilberto's vocal:** Untrained, whispery voice (she wasn't even a professional singer!)
 - **Stan Getz's warm tenor:** Smooth, lyrical tone perfect for bossa nova
 - **Portuguese and English lyrics:** Bilingual version
 - **Simple melody:** Highly singable, became a pop hit
 - **Latin jazz fusion:** Brazilian music meeting American jazz
 - **Antonio Carlos Jobim:** Brazilian composer at piano; wrote the tune
 - **Soft, romantic mood:** Perfect for relaxation; became symbol of 1960s sophistication
 - **Crossover success:** Topped pop charts; introduced bossa nova to American audiences

Key Terms: bossa nova, Latin jazz, crossover hit, Brazilian music, gentle swing, bilingual

Historical Context: This recording became one of the most successful jazz records ever, winning multiple Grammys. It sparked a bossa nova craze in the U.S. and showed jazz's global influences.

Andrew Hill – "Refuge" (1964)

Album: Point of Departure

Piano, composer

What to Listen For:

- **Avant-garde composition:** Complex, through-composed structure
- **Eric Dolphy on alto sax:** Distinctive, wide-interval leaps; vocalized tone
- **Asymmetrical phrases:** Unusual phrase lengths - not standard 4 or 8-bar sections
- **Angular melody:** Dissonant, challenging melodic lines
- **Modern classical influence:** Shows influence of 20th century concert music
- **Joe Henderson on tenor:** Contrasts with Dolphy's angular approach
- **Dense texture:** Multiple voices creating complex polyphony
- **Shifting time feels:** Not steady groove; rhythmic complexity
- **Blue Note modernism:** Represents Blue Note's more experimental side
- **Challenging but structured:** Not free jazz - carefully composed, but difficult

Key Terms: avant-garde, through-composed, asymmetrical phrasing, angular, polyphonic texture, Blue Note modernism

Historical Context: Andrew Hill (1931-2007) was one of Blue Note's most adventurous artists. *Point of Departure* is a masterpiece of "inside-outside" playing - modern but not completely free.

Joe Henderson – "Serenity" (1964)

Album: In 'N Out

Tenor saxophone

What to Listen For:

- **Ballad tempo:** Slow, lyrical mood
- **Henderson's warm tenor tone:** Beautiful, singing quality
- **Modal harmony:** Simple harmonic structure allows melodic development
- **McCoy Tyner on piano:** Quartal voicings similar to his work with Coltrane
- **Elvin Jones on drums:** Subtle, supportive brushwork

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- **Melodic sophistication:** Henderson builds logical, song-like improvisations
 - **Blue Note sound:** High-quality recording; pristine acoustics
 - **Relaxed but engaged:** Not sleepy - maintains intensity while being lyrical
 - **Hard bop meets modal:** Shows how hard bop musicians incorporated modal concepts

Key Terms: ballad, modal harmony, quartal voicings, melodic development, lyrical improvisation

Historical Context: Joe Henderson (1937-2001) was one of the great hard bop/modal tenor saxophonists. He worked with many Blue Note artists and had one of the most distinctive sounds on his instrument.

Wayne Shorter – "Speak No Evil" (1965)

Album: Speak No Evil

Tenor saxophone, composer

What to Listen For:

- **Mysterious, film noir mood:** Dark, shadowy quality
- **Complex melody:** Angular but memorable theme
- **Shorter's unique tone:** Lighter, more speech-like than typical hard bop tenor
- **Freddie Hubbard on trumpet:** Bright, confident trumpet contrasts with Shorter's mystery
- **Herbie Hancock's comping:** Sophisticated harmonic support
- **Minor key:** Gives melancholy, noir feeling
- **Post-bop harmony:** More complex than modal but not traditional bebop changes
- **Blue Note masterpiece:** One of the label's most acclaimed albums
- **Shorter's compositional voice:** Shows him as major composer, not just saxophonist
- **Enigmatic quality:** Music suggests but doesn't state; leaves room for interpretation

Key Terms: film noir mood, post-bop, angular melody, enigmatic, minor tonality, sophisticated harmony

Historical Context: Wayne Shorter was a member of Miles' Second Great Quintet and Art Blakey's Jazz Messengers. This album established him as a major composer and conceptualist, not just a sideman.

John Coltrane – "Acknowledgment" (Part I of *A Love Supreme*) (1965)

Album: A Love Supreme

Tenor saxophone

Classic Quartet: Coltrane, McCoy Tyner (piano), Jimmy Garrison (bass), Elvin Jones (drums)

What to Listen For:

- **Spiritual intent:** This is a prayer/devotional offering to God
- **Modal pedal point:** Bass repeats F pedal throughout
- **"A Love Supreme" chant:** Four-note motif repeated vocally and instrumentally
- **Building intensity:** Starts quiet, builds to ecstatic peak
- **Coltrane's sheets of sound:** Dense cascades of notes expressing spiritual yearning
- **McCoy Tyner's power:** Piano creates massive, orchestral sound with quartal voicings
- **Elvin Jones' polyrhythmic fury:** Drums create swirling, multi-layered rhythms
- **Collective intensity:** All four musicians reach transcendent state together
- **Gospel influence:** Church-like fervor and call-and-response

- **Suite structure:** This is Part I of 4-part work (*Acknowledgment, Resolution, Pursuance, Psalm*)
- **No traditional form:** Open structure allows spiritual expression

Key Terms: spiritual jazz, pedal point, suite, polyrhythm, sheets of sound, transcendence, gospel influence

Historical Context: *A Love Supreme* (1965) is Coltrane's masterpiece - a four-part suite expressing gratitude to God for helping him overcome addiction. It's one of the most important albums in jazz history and represents the peak of spiritual modal jazz.

WEEK 7: FREE JAZZ

Ornette Coleman – "Lonely Woman" (1959)

Album: The Shape of Jazz to Come

Alto saxophone (plastic!), composer

Quartet: Coleman, Don Cherry (pocket trumpet), Charlie Haden (bass), Billy Higgins (drums)

What to Listen For:

- **No chord changes:** Completely free improvisation - no predetermined harmony
- **Haunting, crying melody:** Deeply emotional, mournful theme
- **Plastic alto saxophone:** Coleman played white plastic sax; unusual, vocal-like tone
- **Don Cherry's pocket trumpet:** Small trumpet with softer, more intimate sound
- **Free but structured:** Has a composed head and clear sections
- **Rubato opening:** Bass and drums create loose, floating tempo
- **Collective improvisation:** Soloists play freely while rhythm section responds
- **Emotional directness:** No harmonic complexity hiding the feeling - pure expression
- **Controversial sound:** Many criticized Coleman's "out of tune" playing and harsh tone
- **Revolutionary:** Proved jazz could exist without chord changes

Key Terms: free jazz, plastic sax, pocket trumpet, collective improvisation, rubato, atonality, harmolodics

Historical Context: This 1959 album shocked the jazz world. Many critics said Coleman couldn't play; others saw him as a revolutionary. This track showed free jazz could be deeply emotional and structured, not just chaotic.

Cecil Taylor – "Tales (8 Whisps)" (1966)

Album: Unit Structures

Piano, composer

What to Listen For:

- **Percussive piano clusters:** Taylor attacks piano like a drum; dense tone clusters
- **No traditional melody or harmony:** Completely atonal, no tonal center
- **Extreme dissonance:** Sounds harsh, abrasive to ears used to traditional harmony
- **Classical avant-garde influence:** Influenced by Stravinsky, Bartók, Stockhausen
- **Relentless energy:** Non-stop intensity; physically exhausting to perform and listen
- **Group texture:** Not soloist/accompanist - everyone creates dense collective sound
- **Abstract structure:** No verse/chorus or head-solos-head

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- **Extended techniques:** Uses forearms, elbows on keys; plucks strings inside piano
 - **Completely free:** No predetermined forms, melodies, or harmonies
 - **Cerebral and visceral:** Both intellectually complex and physically overwhelming

Key Terms: atonality, tone clusters, avant-garde, extended techniques, collective texture, abstract form

Historical Context: Cecil Taylor (1929-2018) was the most radical of free jazz pianists, combining European avant-garde classical music with African-American jazz intensity. He remained uncompromising throughout his career.

Eric Dolphy – "Straight Up and Down" (1964)

Album: Out to Lunch

Bass clarinet

What to Listen For:

- **Bass clarinet:** Low, woody sound - uncommon jazz instrument
- **Wide interval leaps:** Dolphy's signature - jumps octaves suddenly
- **Vocalized tone:** Makes instrument sound like human voice crying, shouting
- **Freddie Hubbard's trumpet:** More traditional sound anchors Dolphy's experimentation
- **Angular, jagged melody:** Unpredictable melodic contours
- **Tony Williams' drumming:** Young drummer (18!) playing with incredible sophistication
- **Post-bop harmony:** Not completely free but not traditional changes either
- **Bobby Hutcherson's vibraphone:** Adds color and texture
- **Out to Lunch:** Title captures the music's off-kilter, "outside" quality
- **Humor and seriousness:** Despite avant-garde nature, has playful moments

Key Terms: bass clarinet, wide intervals, vocalized tone, angular melody, post-bop, outside playing

Historical Context: Eric Dolphy (1928-1964) died suddenly at age 36, just months after this recording. *Out to Lunch* is his masterpiece - showing how to be experimental while maintaining accessibility. He also played alto sax and flute at virtuoso levels.

Albert Ayler – "Ghosts" (1964)

Album: Spiritual Unity

Tenor saxophone

Trio: Ayler, Gary Peacock (bass), Sunny Murray (drums)

What to Listen For:

- **Huge, raw tenor tone:** Ayler's sound is massive, unrefined, vocal-like
- **Folk-like melody:** Simple, march-like theme - sounds like children's song or hymn
- **Extreme high register:** Ayler screams in altissimo range (very high notes)
- **No bass walking:** Gary Peacock plays free, melodic lines, not traditional bass role
- **Free time feel:** Sunny Murray's drums create texture, not steady time
- **Honking, crying sounds:** Extended techniques - multiphonics, overtones, screams
- **Spiritual ecstasy:** Music suggests religious trance, speaking in tongues
- **Collective free improvisation:** All three musicians play freely together

- **Simple becomes complex:** Takes simple melody and explodes it into chaos
- **Gospel/spiritual roots:** Despite avant-garde sound, rooted in Black church music

Key Terms: extended techniques, multiphonics, altissimo register, free time, spiritual ecstasy, folk melody, collective improvisation

Historical Context: Albert Ayler (1936-1970) was the most radical tenor saxophonist. His sound was so extreme many couldn't listen to it. John Coltrane was deeply influenced by Ayler. Ayler died mysteriously in 1970 (body found in river).

John Coltrane – "Expression" (1967)

Album: Expression

Tenor saxophone

What to Listen For:

- **Late Coltrane sound:** Harsh, crying tone - very different from earlier lyrical playing
- **Free improvisation:** No chord changes or predetermined structure
- **Spiritual intensity:** Music expresses extreme emotional and spiritual states
- **Alice Coltrane on piano:** His wife plays dense, percussive clusters
- **Screaming, honking:** Coltrane uses extreme techniques; multiphonics, overblowing
- **Rashied Ali on drums:** Free, textural drumming - not traditional timekeeping
- **Dark, apocalyptic mood:** This is not uplifting - sounds like suffering, searching
- **Collective intensity:** All musicians reach extreme states together
- **Coltrane's final period:** Recorded shortly before his death from liver cancer
- **Beyond beauty:** Not trying to be "pretty" - expressing raw truth
- **Influence of Albert Ayler:** Coltrane's sound became more extreme, influenced by Ayler

Key Terms: late Coltrane, free jazz, spiritual intensity, multiphonics, overblowing, collective intensity, apocalyptic

Historical Context: This was recorded in early 1967; Coltrane died in July 1967 at age 40. His final albums are extremely challenging - moving into complete freedom and spiritual extremity. Many fans of earlier Coltrane couldn't follow him here.

QUIZ PREPARATION STRATEGIES

For Factual Questions:

1. **Make flashcards** for key terms and concepts
2. **Create comparison charts** (Bebop vs. Hard Bop vs. Modal vs. Free)
3. **Know the readings** - specific concepts from Szwed, Berliner, Monson, DeVeaux/Giddins
4. **Understand evolution** - how each style emerged from the previous one
5. **Focus on differences** - what makes each artist/movement unique

For Listening Response:

1. **Practice writing** about each song using the terms above
2. **Listen actively** - identify instruments, tempo, form, mood

3. **Use vocabulary** from class - modal, Dorian mode, collective improvisation, sheets of sound, etc.
4. **Connect to context** - mention cultural/historical significance
5. **Aim for 5-6 strong observations** in your paragraph

Essential Artists to Know:

- **Bebop/Hard Bop:** Thelonious Monk, Art Blakey, Horace Silver, Sonny Rollins, Charles Mingus
- **Modal Jazz:** Miles Davis, John Coltrane, Bill Evans, Herbie Hancock, Wayne Shorter
- **Free Jazz:** Ornette Coleman, Cecil Taylor, Eric Dolphy, Albert Ayler

Essential Concepts:

- **Modal jazz** - improvising on modes/scales rather than chord changes
- **Hard bop** - bebop + gospel/blues/R&B; funkier, more soulful
- **Free jazz** - abandoning all traditional structures (harmony, form, time)
- **Sheets of sound** - Coltrane's dense cascades of notes
- **Collective improvisation** - all musicians improvising together
- **Quartal harmony** - chords built on 4ths (McCoy Tyner's sound)
- **Soul jazz** - funky, gospel-influenced substyle of hard bop

COMPARISON CHART: WEEKS 4-7

Element	Bebop Continued	Hard Bop	Modal Jazz	Free Jazz
Dates	1940s-1950s	Mid-1950s	1959-1960s	Early 1960s
Tempo	Fast	Medium-fast	Slow-medium	Variable/Free
Harmony	Complex chord changes	Chord changes + blues	Modes/scales	None (atonal)
Influences	Swing, Parker/Gillespie	Gospel, blues, R&B;	Classical impressionism	Avant-garde classical
Goal	Virtuosity, art music	Soul, groove, Black identity	Space, freedom, meditation	Complete freedom, new language
Key Artists	Monk, Stitt, Dexter Gordon	Blakey, Silver, Rollins	Miles, Coltrane, Evans	Coleman, Taylor, Ayler
Key Albums	<i>Genius of Modern Music</i>	<i>Moanin'</i> , <i>Saxophone Colossus</i>	<i>Kind of Blue</i> , <i>My Favorite Things</i>	<i>The Shape of Jazz to Come</i>
Rhythm Section	Walking bass, ride cymbal	Funkier, gospel-influenced	Freer, more spacious	Completely free, textural
Accessibility	Challenging	More accessible	Very accessible	Very challenging
Cultural Context	Post-WWII art music	Reaction to cool jazz; Black pride	Spiritual exploration	Revolutionary; breaking all rules

Good luck on Friday! You've got this!